
Fw: Follow-up on Governance Concerns & Reported Incident

From ASRCCD Trustee <ASRCCD.Trustee@rccd.edu>

Date Fri 10/24/2025 2:58 PM

To viewpoints <viewpoints@rcc.edu>

Gabriel Graves

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Lead Fellow - **College Corps**

Intern - **Community Action Leadership Academy (CALA)**

Student Trustee - **Riverside Community College District (RCCD)**



From: ASRCCD Trustee

Sent: Tuesday, September 23, 2025 5:04 PM

To: Bottoms, Megan <Megan.Bottoms@rcc.edu>; Cruz-Soto, Thomas <Thomas.Cruz-Soto@rcc.edu>

Subject: Follow-up on Governance Concerns & Reported Incident

Dear Dean Cruz-Soto, and Dr. Bottoms,

I am writing to follow up on my earlier email outlining concerns about governance practices that have made it difficult to carry out my responsibilities as Student Trustee. Since that message, a new issue has been reported to me that further underscores the need for timely intervention.

Today a senator informed me that during an official student government setting the ASRCC President made remarks that:

- Mischaracterized the Student Trustee as “working for the district” rather than serving in an independent, elected capacity to represent all RCCD students.
- Stated that communications I sent regarding funding “should be disregarded,” and that funding is “not for the Trustee”; and
- Directed members “not to take orders” from me in my capacity as Student Trustee.

I share this information not to escalate conflict, but because comments of this nature, if accurate, directly undermine the governing documents we are bound to uphold:

- ASRCC Constitution – Article II, Section 6.9 charges the ASRCC President to “fulfill any duties assigned to them by the RCCD Student Trustee as well as give continual updates regarding RCC activities.”
- Executive Cabinet Bylaws – Article I, Section 3 require compliance with the Brown Act, including timely posting of agendas (72 hours before regular meetings) and professional standards of conduct.
- Executive Cabinet Bylaws – Chapter II, Article 1 state that all members shall “conduct themselves with the integrity and respect appropriate of a Representative of the Association” and that officers shall enforce “reasonable decorum.”

Statements that discredit the Trustee role or instruct others to ignore communications contradict these provisions and create an environment in which it is extremely difficult for me to fulfill my duties of district-wide coordination and representation.

To move forward constructively, I respectfully request:

1. A facilitated meeting with the advisors, the ASRCC President, and myself to clarify the duties and authority of each role under the Constitution and Bylaws; and
2. A written plan and timeline for ensuring consistent compliance with Brown Act posting requirements and with the professional decorum standards cited above.

I remain committed to representing every RCCD student and to collaborating with all campus leadership teams. My goal is not to assign blame, but to ensure that our governance structures operate transparently and according to the rules we have all adopted.

Thank you for your attention to this matter and for helping us protect a healthy and professional environment for student leadership.

Respectfully,

Gabriel Graves

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Lead Fellow - **College Corps**

Intern - **Community Action Leadership Academy (CALA)**

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RCCD

RIVERSIDE COMMUNITY
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